SOCIOECONOMIC FALSE BELIEF #5 · SCARCITY AND SECURITY

"Life is never stable or safe."

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Where it often comes from

Childhood in an unpredictable home, repeated moves, a frightening event, or growing up around constant financial strain can teach the mind that the ground is never solid. When hardship comes often, the nervous system learns to stay on guard, and it can begin to feel as if danger is always near.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture does not promise a life without trouble. Jesus said that in the world we will have tribulation, but that we can take courage because He has overcome the world. God is called our refuge and an ever-present help in trouble. The Bible also invites us to lie down and sleep in peace because God makes us dwell in safety. These verses speak of a steadiness that rests on God, even when circumstances shake.

> *"God is our refuge and strength, an ever-present help in times of trouble. Therefore we will not fear, though the earth is transformed and the mountains are toppled into the depths of the seas"* (Psalm 46:1–2).

Also see

> "I will lie down and sleep in peace, for You alone, O LORD, make me dwell in safety" (Psalm 4:8).

> "Do not fear sudden danger or the ruin that overtakes the wicked, for the LORD will be your confidence and will keep your foot from the snare" (Proverbs 3:25–26).

> "You will keep in perfect peace the steadfast of mind, because he trusts in You" (Isaiah 26:3).

> "I have told you these things so that in Me you may have peace. In the world you will have tribulation. But take courage; I have overcome the world!" (John 16:33).

Common self-statements

- Something bad is always about to happen.
- I can never relax.
- Nothing in life can be counted on.
- I have to stay on guard all the time.
- Safety is for other people.
- Just when things settle down, they fall apart.

Common logical errors

- Overgeneralizing: Turning past instability into "life is always unsafe."
- Fortune telling: Expecting trouble that has not come.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling on edge and concluding that I am in danger.
- Mental filter: Noticing threats while overlooking what is steady.

Challenging questions

- What in my past taught me that life is unstable?

- What, right now, is stable and safe?
- Am I in danger at this moment, or is my body reacting to an old alarm?
- What has God provided in past hard times?
- What does it mean to find refuge in God, not in perfect circumstances?
- What is one small routine I could build that adds stability?
- Who could I talk with if I feel unsafe?

Truth summary

> Life has real uncertainty, and I cannot control everything. But "never stable or safe" is not the whole truth. There are steady things today, and God is my refuge and help in trouble. I can build small routines, trust Him for what I cannot control, and rest.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Refuge/Safety
- Protection
- Peace
- Trust
- Fear

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Trouble/Hardship
- Anxiety/Worry/Fear

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Fear Is a Liar — Zach Williams
Examine fear-driven accusations rather than treating them as reliable truth.

Same Power — Jeremy Camp
God's power challenges the belief that evil or fear has the final authority.

He Knows — Jeremy Camp
Jesus understands suffering and invites people to bring their burdens to Him.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "Life is never stable or safe"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Life is never stable or safe." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What taught me that life is unstable?
- ☐ What is steady today?
- ☐ Am I in danger now, or reacting to an old alarm?
- ☐ What has God provided before?
- ☐ What routine could add stability?
- ☐ Who can I talk to?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God is my refuge, even when life shakes.
- ☐ Some things in my life are steady.
- ☐ I can build small routines that give stability.
- ☐ Feeling on edge does not prove I am in danger.
- ☐ I have gotten through hard times before.
- ☐ I can rest in God's care tonight.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Psalm 46:1–2
  "God is our refuge and strength, an ever-present help in times of trouble. Therefore we will not fear, though the earth is transformed and the mountains are toppled into the depths of the seas."
- ☐ Psalm 4:8
  "I will lie down and sleep in peace, for You alone, O LORD, make me dwell in safety."
- ☐ Isaiah 26:3
  "You will keep in perfect peace the steadfast of mind, because he trusts in You."

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] What was steady today: Each evening, write one thing that was stable or safe today and rate how safe you felt from 0 to 10.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.
  For example, Psalm 4:8 becomes: "Sarah can write: "God makes me dwell in safety, so I can rest tonight.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Peace" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

This card is educational and is not financial or legal advice. Choose steps you can do safely. If you are without food, housing, or safety, contact your church, a trusted advisor, or local assistance services.

- [ ] Build one steady routine. Choose a regular wake-up, meal, or evening routine and keep it for a week.
- [ ] Name what is safe right now. Look around and name five things that are safe in this moment. Breathe slowly while you do.
- [ ] Talk to one trusted person. Share one fear about safety and notice how it feels to be heard.
- [ ] Read a refuge verse aloud. Read Psalm 46:1–2 or Psalm 4:8 slowly each night this week.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Life is never stable or safe": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Something steady
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Life is never stable or safe.~~

THE TRUTH

_____

_____

GOD'S WORD

_____

_____

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, You are my refuge and strength. When my life feels shaky, steady my heart. Help me find rest in Your care, build small steadiness into my days, and trust You with what I cannot control. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.